

CONSULTANCY PLAYBOOK — TABLE OF CONTENTS

1. Professional Identity 2. Core Competencies 3. Engagement Mechanics 4. Client Relationships & Influence 5. Governance & Ethics 6. Quality, Risk & Delivery 7. Creativity, Resilience & Continuous Learning

CONSULTING PRINCIPLES — EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

1. Put the client first — understand, listen, and deliver measurable value. 2. Use facts and structure — always base recommendations on evidence. 3. Build trust — communicate with clarity, honesty, and empathy. 4. Be decisive — simplify complexity and guide the client to action. 5. Deliver excellence — manage time, quality, and relationships rigorously. 6. Act ethically — maintain confidentiality and integrity in all work. 7. Learn and adapt — reflect on feedback and continuously improve.

Title: - Heading: How To Be a Consultant What's Different About Being a Consultant? Introduction to Consulting Subheading: What is a consultant? • A consultant is contracted for a limited time to provide specialized knowledge and skills to a client organization. Subheading: Types of Consultants • There are three main types of consultants: o Freelance consultants: These consultants work for themselves and are responsible for finding their own clients and managing their own work. o Consultants who work for a consultancy firm: These consultants are employed by a consultancy firm and are assigned to client projects by the firm. o Associates: These consultants are not full-time employees of a consultancy firm, but they work with the firm on a regular basis. Subheading: Challenges of Being a consultant • The challenges of being a consultant include: o The need to be self-motivated: Consultants are responsible for their own work and must be able to motivate themselves to complete projects on time and within budget. o The risk of not having enough work: Consultants may experience periods of unemployment between projects. o The need to be able to adapt to different clients and projects: Consultants must be able to quickly learn new things and adapt to the needs of their clients. Subheading: Rewards of Being a consultant • The rewards of being a consultant include: o The flexibility to work from anywhere in the world: Consultants can work from home, from coffee shops, or from anywhere else with an internet connection.

o The opportunity to learn new things: Consultants are exposed to a wide variety of projects and clients, which gives them the opportunity to learn new skills and knowledge. o The potential for high earnings: Consultants can earn a high salary, especially if they are experienced and have a strong network of clients.

Title: - Heading: How To Be a Consultant Being A Consultant? Becoming a consultant: A Comprehensive Guide Sub-heading: Insights from David Lightfoot, COO of Fusion Global Business Services Summary: Defining the essence of consulting, includes emphasizing the role of consultants as experts who provide valuable guidance and solutions to businesses seeking to enhance their operations and achieve their goals. There is a diverse spectrum of consulting disciplines, encompassing IT, management, marketing, and more. To embark on a successful consulting career, it is important to possess a profound understanding of your chosen field, coupled with exceptional communication and relationship-building skills. It is important to build a strong network within your domain to gain recognition and secure initial clients. As a consulting business gains traction, there is a need for flexibility and adaptability, as you may encounter a variety of projects and client requirements. It is important to be passionate about your work and committed to delivering exceptional service to clients. Key takeaways: • Consultants are trusted advisors who provide expert guidance to businesses. • The consulting industry encompasses a wide range of specializations, catering to diverse business needs. • A strong foundation in your chosen field, effective communication, and relationshipbuilding skills are essential for success. • Networking is crucial for establishing a reputation and attracting clients. • Flexibility and adaptability are paramount as you navigate the diverse demands of consulting projects. • Passion and commitment to providing exceptional service are the hallmarks of a successful consultant.

Title: - How To Be a Consultant Presentation Skills? Key Points: • Craft a Compelling Narrative: Captivate your audience with a persuasive story that resonates with their interests and concerns. • Employ Impactful Language: Utilize vivid language, rhetorical devices, and contrasts to make your presentation memorable and engaging. • Integrate Supportive Visuals: Leverage visuals that effectively complement your message, enhance understanding, and reinforce key takeaways. • Structure with Clarity: Organize your presentation logically and concisely, employing the pyramid principle to prioritize and present essential information. • Rehearse Refinement: Dedicate time to practice and refine your presentation, ensuring a polished and confident delivery that reflects your expertise. • Seek feedback from colleagues or mentors to identify areas for improvement and elevate your presentation skills. • Storytelling is significant in crafting effective presentations that resonate with audiences and drive action.

Title: - Heading: How To Be a Consultant What's Different About Being A Consultant? A Comprehensive Guide to the Consulting Profession Key Points: • Consulting Defined: A consultant is an expert who is brought in on a temporary basis to provide specialized knowledge and skills to a client organization. • Types of Consultants: The video distinguishes between three primary consultant categories: freelance consultants, consultants employed by consultancy firms, and associates. • Challenges of Consulting: The speaker highlights the self-motivation and risk management required to thrive in consulting. • Rewards of Consulting: The flexibility to work remotely and the opportunity to continuously learn are emphasized as consulting's allure. • Finding Consulting Opportunities: Networking, attending conferences, and utilizing online job boards are effective strategies for securing consulting gigs.

Title: How To Be A Consultant - Using Methods, Tools & Resources? Key points: • Methods, tools, and resources can help consultants to be more efficient, effective, and successful. • There are many different types of methods, tools, and resources available, so it is important to choose the ones that are right for the project. • Consultants should be familiar with a variety of methods, tools, and resources so that they can adapt to different situations. • Consultants should be able to use methods, tools, and resources effectively to achieve their project goals.

How to Be a Consultant – Analysis & Problem Solving? Key points: • Consultants need to be able to think critically and analyze information effectively. • They also need to be able to communicate their findings clearly and persuasively. • Consultants should be aware of their own biases and take steps to mitigate them. • Scenario analysis is a valuable tool for considering different possibilities and making informed decisions. • Consultants should be prepared for downside scenarios and have contingency plans in place.

Title: - How to be a Consultant Selling Your Work? • What is consulting? o Consulting is about helping other people solve problems. o Consultants are often brought in to deal with complex and difficult situations. • The role of a consultant: o Consultants are independent professionals who provide expert advice and services to clients. o They typically have a deep understanding of a particular industry or business problem. • The importance of understanding your duty of care: o Consultants have a legal and ethical obligation to act in the best interests of their clients. o They must ensure that their advice is accurate and that their work is carried out to a high standard. • How to market yourself as a consultant: o Marketing is essential for getting new business. o You need to be able to clearly articulate what you do and why people should hire you. o You should also build a strong network of contacts in your industry. • The difference between pre-sales and chargeable work: o Pre-sales work is the time you spend marketing, selling, and preparing for a project. o Chargeable work is the time you spend actually working on the project. o It is important to set clear boundaries between pre-sales and chargeable work to avoid confusion about billing. • How to negotiate a fee: o Negotiation is an important part of the consulting process. o You need to be able to value your services accurately and to negotiate a fair fee with your clients.

- Tips for dealing with difficult clients:
 - o Difficult clients are a fact of life for consultants.
 - o There are several things you can do to manage difficult clients, such as:
 - Setting clear expectations from the outset
 - Maintaining open communication
 - Being assertive but professional

Title: How to Be a Consultant – Report Writing? Key Points:

- Define the scope of the report: Before you start writing, it's important to clearly define the scope of the report. This includes understanding what the client expects, the audience for the report, and the format of the report.
- Gather the necessary information: Once you know the scope of the report, you can start gathering the necessary information. This may involve interviewing stakeholders, reviewing documentation, and conducting research.
- Structure the report: The structure of the report is important for making it easy to read and understand. A typical report structure includes an introduction, methodology, findings, recommendations, and a conclusion.
- Write clearly and concisely: Use clear and concise language that is easy for the reader to understand. Avoid jargon and technical terms unless they are necessary.
- Use visuals effectively: Visuals can help to break up text and make the report more engaging. Use charts, graphs, and diagrams to illustrate key points.
- Proofread carefully: Before you submit the report, proofread it carefully for any errors. This will help to ensure that the report is professional and polished.

Additional Tips:

- Be honest with the client: If you don't agree with the client's conclusions, be honest with them. However, be prepared to provide evidence to support your position.
- Be careful when dealing with sensitive information: If the report contains sensitive information, be sure to handle it with care. This may involve redacting sensitive information or using a secure file sharing system.
- Get the client's sign-off: Once the report is complete, get the client's sign-off. This will ensure that they are happy with the content and the format of the report.

Title: Consultant – Creativity? Summary:

How To Be a

- Creativity is an essential skill for consultants, enabling them to develop innovative solutions to complex problems.
- To nurture creativity, consultants should cultivate a psychologically safe space where team members feel comfortable expressing their ideas without fear of judgment.
- Several techniques can stimulate creativity, including brainstorming, mind mapping, and employing analogies and metaphors.
- Maintaining a sense of playfulness and enjoyment during creative endeavours is crucial.

Key points:

- Creativity empowers consultants to tackle challenges with fresh perspectives and effective solutions.
- Establishing a psychologically secure environment is paramount for fostering creative thinking among team members.
- Techniques like brainstorming, mind mapping, and leveraging analogies and metaphors can ignite creativity.
- Embracing a playful and light-hearted approach during creative exercises enhances the process.

Corporate Quality & Risk Management? Heading: Corporate Quality & Risk Management in the Major Consulting Firms

Key Points:

- What is Corporate Quality & Risk Management?
 - o It is a set of rules and processes that consulting firms use to ensure that their work is of high quality and that they are not taking on any unnecessary risks.
 - o The rules and processes are typically published in a manual that is shared with all employees.
 - o There are also education processes in place to make sure that employees understand the rules and processes.
 - o The firm may also have a team of people who review employee work to make sure that it is being done correctly.
- Scope of Corporate Quality & Risk Management
 - o It covers a wide range of topics, including:

Title: How to Be a Consultant –

- Processes: The firm must have processes in place for everything from onboarding new clients to billing for work.
- Clients: The firm must carefully consider whether or not to take on a client, and it must avoid conflicts of interest.
- Legality: The firm must comply with all applicable laws and regulations.
- Taking on work: The firm must carefully consider whether or not to take on a piece of work, and it must make sure that the contract is fair and protects the firm's interests.
- Senior oversight: The firm must have the right level of senior oversight in place to ensure that the work is being done correctly.
- Getting paid: The firm must make sure that it has accurate records and that it can justify all of its expenses.
- Performance reviews: The firm must conduct performance reviews for all employees and provide them with feedback.

• Conclusion

- o Corporate Quality & Risk Management is an important part of working in a consulting firm.

o It helps to ensure that the firm's work is of high quality and that it is not taking on any unnecessary risks.

Title: Consultant - How To Be a Key Points: Fees, Commerciality, Contracts & Finance? •

Consulting encompasses various types, including employed, freelance, and consulting firms. • The most suitable type depends on experience and preferences. • Employed consultants have less commercial responsibilities. • Freelance consultants assume greater commercial obligations. • Qualification: o Scrutinize opportunities to ensure alignment with expertise and interests. o Quantify effort proposed and confidently deliver specified outcomes. o Anticipate potential risks and mitigate through contractual arrangements. • Commercial Aspects: o Standardized contract templates ensure suitability. o Statements of Work clearly define scope and delivery mechanisms. o Independent consultants handle business aspects of consulting assignments. o Understand payment procedures and adhere to client guidelines. o Premium rates for freelance consulting compensate for self-incurred expenses. o Standardized invoice templates guarantee accuracy. o Promptly pursue overdue payments. • Pricing Models: o Time and materials, fixed fee, and contingency fee options exist. o Optimal model depends on project type and client relationship. o Adequately cover expenses and generate profits. • Contracts:

o Familiarize with diverse consulting contracts. o Standardized contract templates ensure effectiveness. o Include all relevant clauses. o Ensure balanced contracts minimizing risk exposure. o Comprehensive Statements of Work detailing work scope and delivery. o Accuracy and alignment with assumptions are crucial for Statements of Work. o Adhere to client payment processes and pursue late payments diligently. • Escrow Services: o Utilize escrow services when working with new clients or on high-value projects. o Comprehend escrow service terms and conditions before engagement. • Risk Mitigation: o Thorough understanding of contracts and client processes safeguards against risks. o Comprehensive knowledge of one's business and proactive risk mitigation strategies are essential. • Clients and Industry Trends: o Consultants interact with public and private sector clients. o Consulting industry commerciality is evolving, necessitating consultants' adaptability.

- Title: How To Be A Consultant Teams & Relationships? In today's complex and ever-changing business environment, teamwork and relationships are more important than ever for consultants. Key challenges that consultants face when working in teams: • Increased regulations: Consultants need to navigate a complex and ever-changing regulatory landscape. • Mental health issues: The demanding nature of consulting can take a toll on mental health. • Diversity: Consultants need to work effectively with people from different backgrounds and perspectives. • Individualism: Consultants need to balance their own needs with the needs of the team. • Digitalization: Consultants need to stay up-to-date with the latest digital technologies. • Transformation: Consultants need to be able to adapt to change and help their clients navigate transformations. To overcome these challenges, the importance of building strong teams that are characterized by trust, safety, and strong teaming skills. Tips for building and leading effective teams, including: • Establishing shared mental models: Ensure that everyone on the team is on the same page about goals, objectives, and priorities. • Creating a safe environment for vulnerability: Encourage team members to be open and honest about their challenges. • Emphasizing the importance of courage and talent: Recognize and reward individual contributions. A consultant, plays a crucial role in building and leading effective teams: • Be a role model: Set a positive example for your team members. • Create a culture of trust and safety: Foster an environment where everyone feels comfortable taking risks and sharing ideas. Mental resilience is essential for consultants to cope with the stress and pressure of their jobs:

• Practicing mindfulness: Take time for relaxation and self-care. • Developing a strong support network: Surround yourself with people who can provide support and encouragement. • Learning to manage your time effectively: Prioritize tasks and avoid procrastination.

Title: How to Be a Consultant – Client Relationships? Summary: Building strong relationships with clients is crucial for success in the consulting industry. Consultants should focus on understanding

their clients' needs, communicating effectively, and being proactive in their approach. Key Points: • Client relationships are essential for consultants to succeed. • Consultants should focus on understanding their clients' needs and business context. • Effective communication is key to building strong client relationships. • Consultants should be proactive in their approach and anticipate their clients' needs. • Consultants should maintain relationships with their clients even after projects are completed.

Title: How to Be a Consultant – The Importance of Solution Design and Buy-in in Consulting? Key Points: • A good solution design is essential for the success of any project. • A solution design should be clear, easy to understand, and aligned with the business goals of the organization. • Stakeholders need to understand the value of the solution and how it will benefit the organization. • Clearly communicate the benefits of the solution. • Address concerns and objections. • Demonstrate the solution's value. • Build relationships with stakeholders. Additional Points: • Solution design is a blueprint for implementing systems and solutions. • There are different types of solution design, including high-level and low-level designs. • There are two main approaches to solution design: waterfall and agile. • Tips for creating a successful solution design: o Clearly define the problem you are trying to solve. o Identify the stakeholders involved. o Gather and analyze requirements. o Develop a solution that meets the requirements. o Document the solution. o Socialize the solution with stakeholders. Trust & Influencing? Key Points:

Title: How to Be a Consultant – • Being a trusted advisor: o The key job of a consultant is to make their client look good, not themselves. o A trusted advisor is someone who understands the client's needs and is committed to helping them achieve their goals. o To be a trusted advisor, you need to be reliable, empathetic, and have a commitment to understanding the client's world. • Stakeholder collaboration: o There are three different situations where a consultant may be involved in change: designing a change, selling a change, or implementing a change. o The best way to approach stakeholder collaboration is to co-create the change with the stakeholders involved. o If you are not able to co-create the change, you should still talk to the stakeholders individually and listen to their concerns. • The science of influence: o There are six principles of persuasion: social proof, commitment and consistency, liking, authority, reciprocity, and scarcity. o To be more persuasive, you should use these principles to your advantage. Ethics & Behaviours? Summary: Ethics are essential for consultants because they help to build trust and credibility with clients. The trust equation is a model that explains how trust is built. The trust equation is: $\text{Trust} = \text{Credibility} + \text{Reliability} + \text{Intimacy} - \text{Self-orientation}$

Title: How to Be a Consultant – Consultants should focus on building credibility, reliability, and intimacy with their clients. She also warns against being self-oriented, which can damage trust. It is important to be mindful of how you present yourself and your work in a virtual setting. The importance of building relationships with clients, even when you are not working with them in person. Important to assess whether you are qualified to work with a particular client. Important to be honest about your experience and expertise. Should be willing to learn from your clients. Key Points: • Ethics are essential for consultants because they help to build trust and credibility with clients. • The trust equation is a model that explains how trust is built. • Consultants should focus on building credibility, reliability, and intimacy with their clients. • It is important to be mindful of how you present yourself and your work in a virtual setting. • It is important to build relationships with clients, even when you are not working with them in person. • It is important to be honest about your experience and expertise. • You should be willing to learn from your clients. Helping People to Change? Summary: • The role of a consultant is changing from delivering solutions to helping people to change. • Consultants need to be able to understand the customer's business needs and goals. • Consultants need to be flexible and adaptable to meet the changing needs of their clients.

Title: How to Be a Consultant – • Consultants need to be able to overcome resistance to change and build relationships with their clients.

Title: - How to be a Consultant Thought Leadership and Reputation? Heading: Thought Leadership and Reputation in Consulting Subheading: Building a Strong Reputation Through Thought

Leadership Key Points: • Thought leadership is a powerful tool for consultants to build their reputation and attract clients. • Thought leaders are experts in their field who share their insights and opinions with others. • There are many different ways to develop thought leadership, such as writing articles, giving speeches, and participating in social media. • The most important thing is to be consistent and to focus on providing valuable content to your audience.

Title: - How To Be a Consultant Interviews, Fact -Finding & Evidence? Summary: Consultants should be aware of the emotions, assumptions, and interpretations that can influence their work. He also stresses the importance of using a variety of sources of information to gather data. To effectively gather information, consultants can use tools such as the six interrogatives, the five wise, clean language, and empathy. Consultants should be empathetic and pay attention to the needs of their clients. Key Points: • Consultants should be aware of the emotions, assumptions, and interpretations that can influence their work. • Consultants should use a variety of sources of information to gather data. • Consultants should use tools such as the six interrogatives, the five wise, clean language, and empathy to gather information effectively. • Consultants should be empathetic and pay attention to the needs of their clients.

How to Be a Consultant – Managing Projects and Mixed Teams? Key Points: • Understand your duty of care: As a consultant, you have a responsibility to ensure that the work you do is safe and meets the needs of your clients. • Build rapport with your team: Develop relationships with your team members and understand their perspectives. • Develop empathy: Be able to understand and appreciate the feelings of others. • Manage projects with mixed teams: Be aware of the challenges of working with people from different backgrounds and cultures. • Follow the process: Use a structured approach to project management to avoid problems. • Record decisions: Keep track of the decisions that are made during the project. • Build a peer group: Connect with other consultants who can provide support and advice. • Set realistic budgets and schedules: Don't rush into making decisions without understanding the problem fully. • Have good administrative support: This can help to keep the project on track. • Find people who are willing to share and help each other: These are the people who will make the best consultants. • Be a trusted advisor: Build trust with your clients and team members. How to be a Consultant Getting Decisions Made & Delivered? Heading: Navigating the Complexities of Organizational Decision -Making Sub-heading: The Role of Consultants in Facilitating Informed and Effective Choices Key Points: • Decision -making is not always a purely rational exercise. Human emotions, biases, and political dynamics can influence decision -making, potentially leading to suboptimal outcomes.

Title: - • Consultants play a pivotal role in bringing a fresh perspective and specialized expertise to the decision -making process. They assist organizations in identifying and addressing the intricacies of complex decision -making environments. • Consultants facilitate consensus -building among stakeholders, ensuring that decisions are well -informed and garner organizational support. This collaborative approach enhances the likelihood of successful decision implementation. • Consultants leverage data and evidence to support their recommendations, lending credibility and objectivity to the decision -making process. This data -driven approach strengthens the rationale behind proposed actions. • Consultants navigate the political landscape surrounding decision -making, ensuring that decisions are made fairly and transparently. They help to mitigate power dynamics and promote ethical decision -making practices. Additional Insights: • Consultants must be mindful of their own biases and limitations, recognizing the power dynamics within organizations. This self -awareness fosters a more objective and unbiased approach to decision -making. • Consultants prioritize building strong relationships and trust with their clients. This fosters a receptive environment for their recommendations and increases the likelihood of successful implementation. • Consultants demonstrate flexibility and adaptability, tailoring their approach to the specific needs and nuances of each organization. This responsiveness ensures that their expertise is effectively applied in diverse contexts. Conclusion: Consultants can play a crucial role in assisting organizations in making sound decisions. By bringing a fresh perspective, specialized expertise, and an objective approach, consultants can help organizations achieve their goals more effectively.

How to be a Consultant Successful Delivery and Beyond? Key Points:

- Agile delivery is a methodology that prioritizes iterative development and ongoing feedback. It excels in handling projects with fluctuating requirements or evolving priorities.
- Scrum teams are multidisciplinary units tasked with delivering a product or service. They typically comprise a product owner, a scrum master, and a development team.
- User stories are concise descriptions of a user's needs from a product or service. They are written from the user's perspective and should be easily understandable and prioritized.
- Global complexity can pose challenges for agile teams, as it necessitates seamless coordination and communication across diverse time zones and cultures.
- Measuring success is crucial for any project, but it is particularly critical for agile endeavours. Agile teams should focus on tracking progress and delivering value to the client early and often.